[10] Although we'd usually talk about n-ary trees, we also usually reserve n to denote the number of entries in a container (or, in general, the input size for a problem). To avoid confusion, then, we will use k for the size of the alphabet and, consequently, the term k-ary.

[11] This quantity here is completely arbitrary; real objects in programming languages have an overhead, which can be way larger than 4 bytes (for instance, usually between 8 and 16 bytes in Java or C++).

[12] As explained in appendix E, whenever in a method defined using recursion the recursive call is limited to the very last operation, compilers can optimize the target machine code by rewriting code using explicit loops instead of function calls. The caveat is that not all compilers provide this optimization.

[13] Since the set of keys for the hash table, i.e. the alphabet, is static and known in advance, it is possible to use perfect hashing and obtain worst-case constant time lookup. See appendix C for more details.

[14] Notice that, since we just created this node `N`, it will be the only node in its subtree.

[15] http://stackoverflow.com/questions/588004/is-floating-point-math-broken/27030789#27030789

[16] https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/IEEE_floating_point#Basic_formats

[17] The original name for this DS, Patricia tree, is an acronym: Morrison, Donald R. "PATRICIA—practical algorithm to retrieve information coded in alphanumeric." Journal of the ACM (JACM) 15.4 (1968): 514-534.

[18] Except a constant overhead for the array object, in most languages.

[19] Sinha, Ranjan, and Justin Zobel. "Efficient trie-based sorting of large sets of strings." Proceedings of the 26th Australasian computer science conference-Volume 16. Australian Computer Society, Inc., 2003.

[20] With exceptions, for instance the *bignum* integer type in Python can represent arbitrarily large numbers, using a variable number of bytes.